Rhea Manocha

Product Designer

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Summary

Product designer with 6 years at Microsoft designing AI-powered collaboration experiences across Word, Copilot Chat, and Teams. I turn ambiguous problems into shipped designs through prototyping, customer research, and cross-functional alignment, with a foundation in accessibility and design systems.

Experience.

Microsoft

Mar 2020 – Present

Office Shared Experiences · Product Designer — May 2025 – Present

- Own the design of **Catch Up**, a Copilot Chat skill that summarizes document changes, mentions, and activity with clear attribution; took it from concept to release and authored the spec engineering built from.
- Set the UX vision for catching up across Word's flyout, Top of Doc, and Copilot Chat, aligning design, PM, and engineering through workshops and a leadership share-out.
- Led the pivot from flyout to Copilot Chat, with a crawl-walk-run roadmap and phased Fluent stylistic updates to reduce engineering risk.
- Ran concept testing (9 interviews) and co-dev sessions; findings favoring structured output over long prose shaped the orient-to-action model behind the experience.

Office AI Experiences & Automation · UX Designer — Jun 2024 – May 2025

- Design owner for **Gather V1** in Copilot Actions, which collects information from coworkers; led the UX end to end through release, with strong customer and partner interest.
- Built the vision prototype for **agentic Gather**; it earned executive sponsorship, informed a strategic pivot, and became the blueprint for a working proof of concept.
- Led a 5-treatment concept study, designed Gather in Teams, and wrote accessibility specs reviewed by experts.

Microsoft Stream · UX Designer & Researcher — Mar 2020 – Jun 2024

- Led the redesign of screen recording and backdrop, with a **9.9% increase in start-to-upload completion rates** in early data.
- Led light, dark, and high-contrast theming on Fluent variables and designed 10+ growth experiments; my Hubble backdrops spec unblocked Outlook GA.
- Led accessibility research (27 interviews with people with disabilities and experts) and ran 100+ interviews and usability tests overall.

Projects.

Mothers on the Rise · Lead Designer — Jan 2022 – Oct 2022

- Designed a 75-page illustrated health booklet for women leaving prison; distributed in the Indiana Women's Prison and presented at APHA.

benefit.design · Co-founder — Mar 2020 – Aug 2021

- Co-founded a nonprofit connecting student volunteer designers with small businesses; led co-design sessions and mentored volunteers.

Education.

Purdue University

Aug 2016 – Dec 2019

UX Design, Bachelor of Science · Minors in Psychology and Management

Skills.

UX & UI design · Prototyping (Figma, Claude, GitHub Copilot) · Conversational & agent UX · User research · Usability testing · Design systems · Co-design · Accessibility · Storytelling